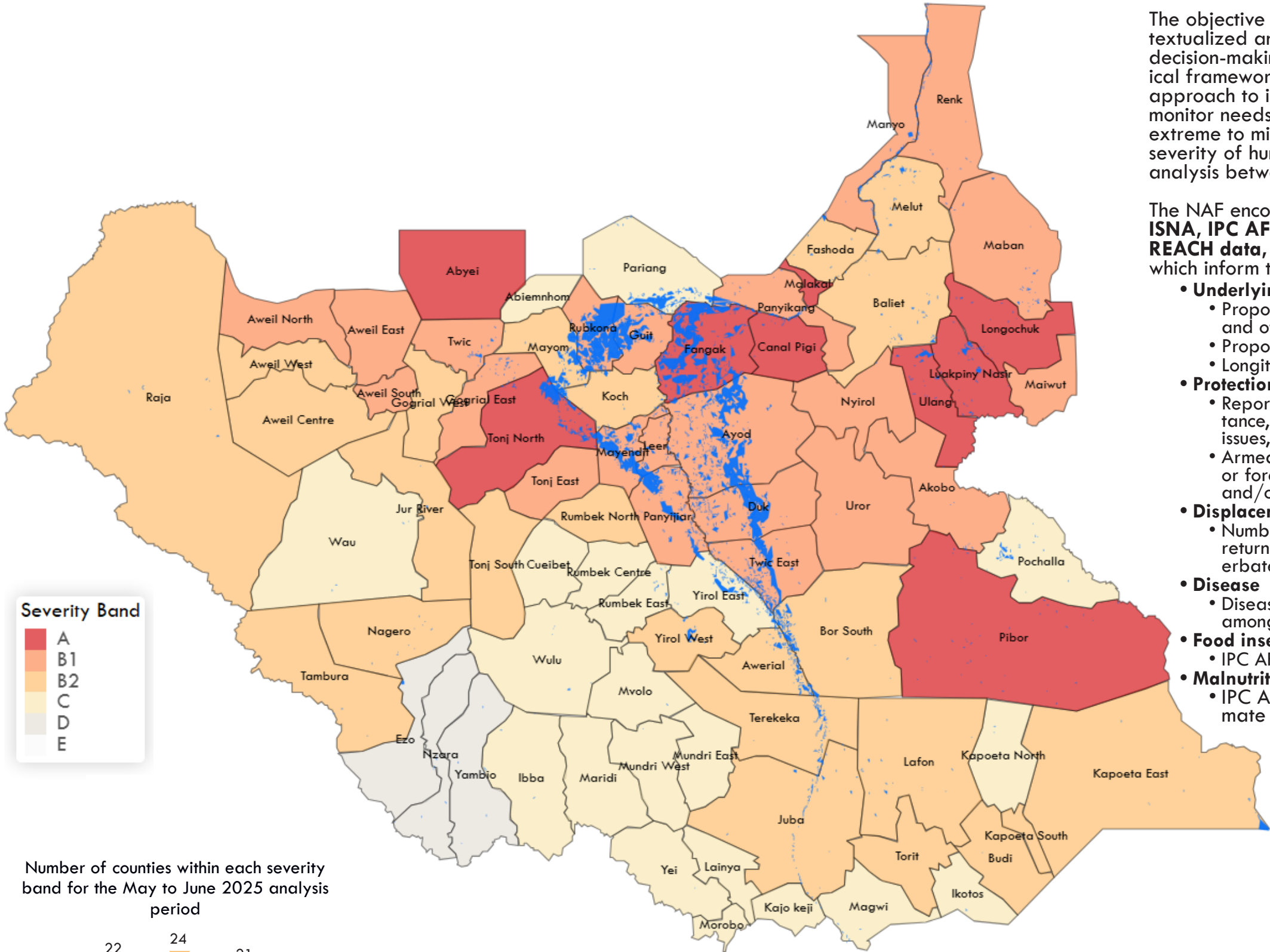
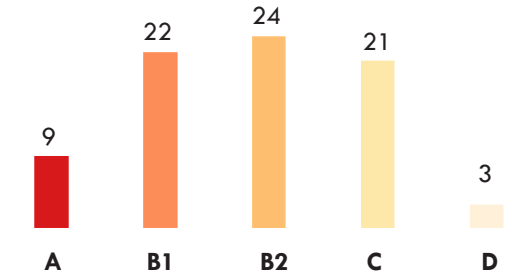


SOUTH SUDAN - NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

May - June 2025 Analysis



Number of counties within each severity band for the May to June 2025 analysis period



For more information on the Needs Analysis Working Group or the NAWG Analytical Framework, please contact Felix Omuu (omuu@un.org) or Rebecca Hetzer (rebecca.hetzer@impact-initiatives.org).

Background

The NAWG meeting was held on July 1st, 2025 to discuss the analysis from the **May to June** period.

The objective of the NAWG is to conduct evidence-based and contextualized analysis of essential needs across South Sudan to inform decision-making and prioritization. To enable this, the NAWG analytical framework (NAF) was developed. The NAF provides a systematic approach to interpret a wide array of multi-sectoral information and monitor needs at the county-level. The final classification (ranging from extreme to minor humanitarian needs) is an intersectoral measure of the severity of humanitarian conditions in a county, allowing for comparative analysis between counties and across time.

The NAF encompasses data from a variety of sources (including **FSNMS, ISNA, IPC AFI and AMN, SMART surveys, JMMI, ACLED, IRNAs, REACH data, IOM DTM, WHO IDSR, PRMS, and data from Clusters**) which inform the following indicators:

- **Underlying vulnerability**
 - Proportion of female-headed households, child-headed households and other vulnerable-group headed households
 - Proportion of IDPs and/or returnees compared to host communities
 - Longitudinal food insecurity
- **Protection**
 - Reports of explosive hazards, lack of access to humanitarian assistance, restriction of movement, sexual violence, family separation, HLP issues, child labour, civil documentation issues, among others
 - Armed conflict events and/or conflict-related sexual violence and/or forced recruitment of children and/or targeted killings of civilians and/or targeted property destruction
- **Displacement**
 - Number of displaced persons arriving and/or number of returnees returning, as significant numbers of arrivals has the potential to exacerbate food and resource access
- **Disease**
 - Disease outbreaks, including cholera, measles, meningitis, and malaria, among others
- **Food insecurity**
 - IPC AFI classifications are used for each county
- **Malnutrition**
 - IPC AMN classifications or SMART survey data are used to estimate crude mortality

Needs severity levels

Severity band	Indicator threshold	Severity level definitions
A	8 - 10	Extreme humanitarian conditions
B1	7 - 7.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (higher severity)
B2	6 - 6.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (lower severity)
C	4 - 5.9	Moderate humanitarian conditions
D	2 - 3.9	Stressed humanitarian conditions
E	0 - 1.9	Minor or acceptable humanitarian conditions

SOUTH SUDAN - NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

May - June 2025 Analysis

Counties facing “extreme” humanitarian conditions

Based on the backend analysis, eight counties were initially classified as ‘Band A’, namely: **Fangak, Tonj North, Longochuk, Nasir, Pibor, Ulang, Abyei, and Malakal.**

Following in-depth discussion and contextual analysis during the NAWG meeting, **Canal/Pigi** was also classified as exhibiting extreme humanitarian needs (Band A).

Discussion and joint analysis

- **Canal-Pigi:** Flagged due to ongoing conflict, including high-intensity aerial bombardments and shelling reported in May. It was noted that the county is facing a high needs caseload and significant, severe access challenges. High taxes imposed on river transport are reportedly reducing the number of commercial boats, choking supply lines and contributing to a highly concerning food security situation. Recent data indicated that over 4,200 people were displaced within Canal-Pigi, with other reports of movement towards areas outside the county, such as Fangak. **Final classification: Elevated from Band B1 to Band A.**
- **Tonj East:** Flagged for discussion due to intercommunal violence. While displacement data was included in the backend analysis, it was also noted during the discussion that the resulting population movement was relatively small. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B1.**
- **Twic East:** Flagged due to intercommunal conflict centered on fishing islands, with 24 fatalities and 13 injuries reported. Despite the severity of the violence, resulting displacement was reported to be minimal. It was noted that a similar incident occurred last year, highlighting the underlying and recurring vulnerability of the community. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B1.**
- **Panyijiar:** Flagged due to a deterioration of protection risks identified in the backend analysis, which was driven by a recent airstrike and two reported incidents of intercommunal conflict between different local clans. It was noted that there was no reported displacement as a direct result of the airstrike. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B1.**
- **Panyikang:** Flagged due to multiple, compounding stressors including airstrikes, ongoing insecurity, and shelling. Significant operational challenges persist, with reports indicating that only two payams are considered accessible to humanitarian partners. An estimated 20,000 IDPs are reported to be in the county, though verification of this figure remains challenging due to access constraints. Furthermore, an incident around Canal-Pigi on June 14-15 reportedly extended into Panyikang, causing additional displacement towards

Fashoda, Malakal, and within Panyikang. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B1.**

- **Tonj South:** Flagged due to significant and large-scale instances of intercommunal violence. This protracted violence led to the displacement of approximately 48,000 individuals in May. While an emergency assessment was conducted, a planned humanitarian response was reportedly not implemented due to conflict sensitivity concerns. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B2.**
- **Renk:** Flagged due to a notable deterioration in health and nutrition outcomes, particularly among the population in the Transit Center. Poor nutrition outcomes were reported, especially for children. The cholera situation worsened significantly in late June, with five cholera deaths recorded in Wunthou/Joda in a single week, compared to only two in the first half of the year. Concurrently, a Hepatitis E outbreak is ongoing in Gosfami. A critical operational constraint is the suspension of onward transportation assistance for returnees on June 1st, leading to increased congestion. This is particularly concerning with the onset of the rainy season, which will likely further deteriorate living conditions. The situation has led to protests in the Transit Center. **Elevated from Band B2 to Band B1.**
- **Mayom:** Flagged due to cattle raiding incident in early May, followed by a reported aerial bombardment in June. A state of emergency was officially declared by the government in Warrap State and Mayom County on June 5th. Disarmament campaigns have reportedly begun, and while they have reportedly been peaceful thus far, there are concerns about potential conflict if communities resist disarmament efforts. No significant displacement was reported following the aerial bombardment, though there were reports of an attack on a boat resulting in fatalities. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B2, added to close monitoring.**
- **Mundri East & West:** These two counties were discussed together due to linked armed clashes in mid-June. The clashes in Mundri East have reportedly resulted in the displacement of civilians fearing a resurgence of conflict. Further clashes in Mundri West have reportedly led to the closure of the critical Mundri-Maridi and Mundri-Juba supply routes due to insecurity. Confirmed displacement figures were not available at the time of the meeting. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C for both.**
- **Morobo:** Flagged due to a direct attack on the Morobo County Hospital on June 20th. An emergency response is reportedly ongoing, with cash for food, nutrition, NFI, and health interventions planned or conducted. Some partners reportedly maintain access to the area. An assessment is currently underway to verify reports of population movement from Morobo towardsainya County. It was also noted that some individuals who had previously fled to Uganda were reportedly forced to return, adding to the vulnerable

population in the county. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C, added to close monitoring.**

Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring

The following counties have been flagged for close monitoring to encourage partners to pay close attention to these counties and share any relevant information.

- **Fangak (Band A):** Close monitoring is warranted due to ongoing conflict. An assessment is reportedly underway to understand the situation of approximately 26,000 IDPs in areas that are also experiencing ongoing cholera and Hepatitis outbreaks.
- **Tonj North (Band A):** Close monitoring is warranted due to displacement recorded in May affecting 8,465 people, compounded by multiple recent security incidents in June.
- **Nasir & Ulang (Band A):** Require close monitoring as 5% of the population in both counties is classified as being in IPC AFI Phase-5 (Catastrophe). Additionally, both counties are classified as being in IPC AMN Phase-5 (Extremely Critical).
- **Pibor (Band A):** Close monitoring is warranted as 5% of the population is classified as being in IPC AFI Phase-5 (Catastrophe).
- **Malakal (Band A):** Close monitoring is warranted as 5% of the population is classified as being in IPC AFI Phase-5 (Catastrophe). The continued closure of the Old Malakal route is reportedly impacting market functionality.
- **Akobo (Band B1):** Close monitoring is warranted due to ongoing challenges with the prepositioning of humanitarian supplies. Security concerns have reportedly impeded the movement of aid destined for other locations like Nasir and Ulang through Akobo, with only life-saving supplies such as drugs being permitted.
- **Maban (Band B1):** Close monitoring is warranted due to reports of a notable reverse movement of people being transported from Maban back to Sudan.
- **Rubkona (Band B1):** Close monitoring is warranted as the county is classified as being in IPC AMN Phase-5 (Extremely Critical). Sites located outside the main camps in Bentiu are considered particularly vulnerable.
- **Baliet (Band B2):** Close monitoring is warranted as the county is classified as being in IPC AMN Phase-5 (Extremely Critical). Concerns were also raised about the accessibility of the Sobat River Corridor, which is a critical supply route for the county and prone to disruptions.